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Max Fineman

Academic Positions

NYU Wagner School of Public Service
Postdoctoral Associate

Education

Princeton University, Department of Sociology
Ph.D., Sociology & Social Policy, 2026
M.A., Sociology, 2023
Dissertation: "Distributional Architectures: How Housing Markets Make American Inequality"
Committee: Matthew Desmond (chair), Adam Goldstein, Patrick Sharkey, John N. Robinson III
General exams: Causal Inference, Economic Sociology, Stratification, Social Policy, Social Networks, Urban Sociology

Columbia University
B.A., Philosophy, 2018
Phi Beta Kappa, *magna cum laude*

Research Interests

Economic sociology	Social Policy
Poverty & Inequality	Quantitative Methodology

Peer-reviewed Publications

Goldstein, Adam and Max Fineman. 2026. "Bad Timing: Mass-Participatory Asset Bubbles as a Mechanism of Predatory Inclusion," **Social Forces**.

Under Review

"Exclusion as Market Infrastructure: How Barriers to Homeownership Sustain Corporate Investment in Single-Family Housing." Conditionally accepted at *American Sociological Review*.

- IPM Robert D. Mare Award for Best Graduate Student Paper in Inequality, Poverty, and Mobility (ASA), 2026.

Working Papers

"The Long-term Effects of Rent Regulation on Children: Evidence from World War II-Era Federal Rent Control."

- Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Grant winner (2025)

"Housing Tenure and Intergenerational Mobility in an Era of Rising Unaffordability: Evidence from 40 Years of Tax Data."

"Mortality Rates are Diverging Between the Children of Owners and Renters."

Research in Progress

"Is There Negative Selection into Homeownership? Heterogeneous Treatment Effects of Homeownership by Tenure Status"

"The Causal Effect of Childhood Exposure to Rising Housing Prices on Adult Outcomes: Heterogeneity by Housing Tenure"

"Who Captures the Gains in Rental Housing Markets? Evidence from Tax Data"

"The Distribution of Realized Capital Gains on Housing"

"Birth Lottery? House Price Appreciation and the Intergenerational Transmission of Wealth"

Presentations

Unaffordability and the Corporate Concentration of Housing Wealth: Structural Shifts in U.S. Housing Markets

- ISI Wealth Conference. Munich. October 2025. Oral presentation.
- Annual meeting of the American Sociological Association. Chicago. August 2025. Oral presentation.

The long-term effects of rent regulation on children: Evidence from World War II-era rent control policies.

- RC28 Summer Meeting. August 2026. New York, NY. Oral Presentation.
- IPUMS Data-Intensive Research Conference. Minneapolis, MN. July 2026. Oral Presentation.
- Consortium on the American Political Economy Summer Workshop. June 2024. Berkeley, CA. Oral Presentation.

Capitalizing on Crisis, but How? Foreclosures and the Rise of Corporate Investment in Housing

- American Sociological Association Annual Meeting. Montreal, Canada. August 2024. Oral Presentation.
- Social Science History Association Annual Meeting. Washington D.C. November 2023. Oral Presentation
- Association of Public Policy and Management Annual Meeting. Washington D.C. November 2022. Oral Presentation.

Bad Timing: Mass-Participatory Asset Bubbles as Mechanisms of Predatory Inclusion.

- Society for the Advancement of Socioeconomics Annual Meeting. University of Amsterdam, Netherlands. July 2022. Oral Presentation.

Evaluating Unsupervised Topic Models with Supervised Text Classification.

- American Sociological Association Annual Meeting. Los Angeles. August 2022. Oral Presentation.
- Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting. Washington University in St. Louis. July 2022. Oral Presentation.

Teaching

Graduate Applied Social Statistics, Graduate Teaching Assistant	Fall 2022
Data and Statistics Consultant, Stokes Social Science Library	2023-2024
Social Networks, Graduate Teaching Assistant	Fall 2021
Police Violence, #BlackLivesMatter, and the Covid-19 Pandemic, Graduate Teaching Assistant	Spring 2023

Grants & Awards

ASA Robert Mare Award for Best Graduate Student Paper in Inequality, Poverty, and Mobility	2026
Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Research Grant	2025-2026
Prize Fellowship in the Social Sciences, Princeton University	2024-2025
Columbia Philosophy Senior Thesis Honors	2018
Columbia Phi Beta Kappa	2018
Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin German Language Fellowship	2017
Columbia College Oxford/Cambridge Scholarship	2016
Columbia College Dean's Scholarship	2014-2018

Service

Reviewer, *American Journal of Sociology*

Princeton Sociology Graduate Student Advisory Council	2022-2023
Princeton Sociology Works in Progress Co-coordinator	2022-2023

Member, American Sociological Association, Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics, RC28

References

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